Santa's Christmas Eve journey

@ET · etymo.co.uk
carTOONography

Santa delivers presents when midnight arrives. But midnight doesn't arrive everywhere at once!

It starts in the middle of the Pacific Ocean and travels west around the world, one time zone at a time. Follow Santa from 1 to 18.





North Pole: Santa's workshop

16 North Pole, Alaska

9 Rovaniemi

7 Moscow

12 London

14 New York

11 Rome

10 Athens

4 Tokyo

6 Mumbai

5 Manila

8 Addis Ababa

17 Honolulu

15 Mexico City

1 Kiritimati

← over the Date Line

18 Pago Pago

13 Rio de Janeiro





...and back in from here ←

3 Sydney

2 Auckland

-11	-10	-9	-8	-7	-6	-5	-4	-3	-2	-1	0	+1	+2	+3	+4	+5	+6	+7	+8	+9	+10	+11	+12

Time zones: hours ahead of (+) or behind (-) London. Kiritimati is +14!

Santa's timetable: when midnight arrives, in London time

1 Kiritimati 10 am, Christmas Eve	**2 Auckland** 11 am, Christmas Eve	**3 Sydney** 1 pm, Christmas Eve	**4 Tokyo** 3 pm, Christmas Eve	**5 Manila** 4 pm, Christmas Eve	**6 Mumbai** 6:30 pm, Christmas Eve
7 Moscow 9 pm, Christmas Eve	**8 Addis Ababa** 9 pm, Christmas Eve	**9 Rovaniemi** 10 pm, Christmas Eve	**10 Athens** 10 pm, Christmas Eve	**11 Rome** 11 pm, Christmas Eve	**12 London** 12 am, Christmas Day
13 Rio de Janeiro 3 am, Christmas Day	**14 New York** 5 am, Christmas Day	**15 Mexico City** 6 am, Christmas Day	**16 North Pole, Alaska** 9 am, Christmas Day	**17 Honolulu** 10 am, Christmas Day	**18 Pago Pago** 11 am, Christmas Day

First and last

Kiritimati (1) is first to reach Christmas Day and Pago Pago (18) one of the last, yet they're only 2,300 km apart. The Date Line runs between them.

Santa has 25 hours!

Midnight takes 25 hours to travel from Kiritimati to Pago Pago, so Christmas Eve lasts more than a whole day.

The coloured stripes are time zones: places in the same stripe reach midnight at the same moment. Map data: Natural Earth (time zones show standard time) · Drawings and map by @ET · etymo.co.uk